

INVESTOR BRIEFING · RENEWED FROM DRAFT 1.2 (25 JULY 2025)

Private K-12 Education in Morocco

Market Overview & Opportunity Analysis

Ellesmere College International

Version 2.0 — March 2026

Renewal of Neil Tomalin, Draft 1.2 (25 July 2025).

Investor / brand-licensing audience. Facts checked against public 2025–26 sources.

What changed in this renewal: national enrolment (2025–26 Ministry figures); tuition benchmarks from published 2025/26–2026/27 schedules; British competition wording where the original overstated white space; Law 59.21 fee/contract rules; tone shifted from internal board instructions to partner opportunity language.

1. Executive summary

Morocco remains a high-potential growth market for partners building under the Ellesmere brand. Fundamentals are intact: a large youth population, rising urban affluence, bilingualism, political stability, and national reforms that still emphasise quality and internationalisation. The private K-12 sector is less mature than the Gulf, but it is no longer a thin fringe market.

What is new since Draft 1.2 (July 2025): Ministry figures for the 2025-26 school year put national enrolment at about 8.27 million students, of whom about 1.27 million ($\approx 15\%$) attend private institutions. That replaces the report's older ~ 8.0 million / ~ 1.1 million (2022/23) framing. British and English-medium provision has also thickened in Greater Casablanca and Rabat — so the commercial thesis is differentiation on heritage brand, pastoral quality and a clear mid-premium fee band, not an empty market.

The mid-premium band of MAD 60,000-90,000 per year remains the right commercial alignment for an Ellesmere-licensed campus: above most French-mission and entry British offers, well below elite American / IB premiums. Casablanca international schools that publish fees still cluster around a mid-60s MAD thousand median.

Partner priorities (unchanged ranking logic; refreshed competition wording)

- Rabat — flagship visibility, diplomatic / professional demand, strong cultural fit.
- Bouskoura / Greater Casablanca suburbs — scale and deliverable sites; compete with existing British provision (BISC, London Academy), do not claim first-mover exclusivity.
- Tangier — industrial growth corridor; Cambridge-linked schools exist; mid-fee British heritage density still lighter than Casa-Rabat.
- Later: Marrakesh, Agadir, Témara-Salé overflow; Fès / El Jadida as watchlist or partnership-led plays.

Primary commercial model for readers of this briefing: brand licensing. Capital and operating partners build and run the school under the Ellesmere name; ECI provides curriculum frameworks, quality assurance, leadership support and network governance. Curriculum / advisory services are optional add-ons, not peer products.

2. Market targeting matrix

Same dimensions as Draft 1.2: market scale, mid/upper-mid income base for MAD 60–90k fees, competition saturation, regulatory / investment support, and composite opportunity. Competition ratings for Bouskoura and Tangier are edged up versus Draft 1.2 to reflect active British / Cambridge provision.

Location	Scale	Income fit	Competition	Opportunity
Bouskoura (Casa suburbs)	Med-High	Strong	Medium	Very High
Rabat	High	Strong	Medium	Very High
Tangier	Med-High	Rising	Low-Med	High
Central Casablanca	Very High	Strong	High	Medium
Marrakesh	Medium	Moderate	Medium	Moderate
Agadir	Medium	Moderate	Low-Med	Medium
Témara / Salé	Medium	Moderate	Low	High (overflow)
Fès / El Jadida	Med-Low	Lower	Low	Watchlist

Regional scorecard (1-5; higher is stronger — except competition = saturation)

Region	Demand	Income	Fee fit	Reg.	Comp.	UK curr.	Culture	Total
Rabat	5	5	5	5	3	4	5	32
Central Casa	5	5	4	4	4	4	4	30
Bouskoura	4	5	5	4	3	3	5	29
Tangier	4	4	4	4	2	3	5	26
Témara/Salé	3	4	4	4	2	2	4	23
Marrakesh	3	3	3	4	3	2	4	22
Agadir	3	3	3	4	2	2	4	21
Fès/El Jadida	2	2	2	3	1	1	3	14

Score changes vs Draft 1.2: Bouskoura competitive saturation raised from 2→3; composite still Tier 1. Rabat remains the highest weighted score.

3. Macro overview (updated)

Demographics

Morocco's population is about 38.4 million (2025), with roughly a quarter under age 15 and urbanisation around two-thirds. Demand concentrates in Greater Casablanca, Rabat-Salé-Témara, Tangier, Marrakesh, Fès and Agadir. Education is compulsory through lower secondary; primary enrolment is near-universal.

Public vs private enrolment — refreshed

Draft 1.2 cited ≈ 8.0 million K-12 students (2022/23) with ≈ 1.1 million private ($\sim 14\%$). For 2025-26, the Minister of National Education reported 8,271,256 enrolled students: 7,004,533 public (+3.4%) and 1,266,723 private. Private share is therefore about 15% of the national system — consistent with the longer-run rise from $\sim 10\%$ in the 2000s.

The structural geography in Draft 1.2 still holds: private schools remain heavily clustered along the Casablanca-Kénitra corridor. Secondary cities are thinner but relevant for later network phases.

Regulatory environment — refreshed

The enabling stance toward private and international education continues, with tighter consumer-protection style oversight. Law 59.21 (school education code) requires written annual parent-school contracts, continuous publication of fee lists (registration, tuition, insurance, catering, transport), and prohibits in-year fee increases. Foreign curricula may be offered subject to authorisation; schools must still deliver programmes that respect national identity (including Arabic / Amazigh pathways).

There remains no general prohibition on foreign participation via local structures; Ministry authorisation and Moroccan content obligations still apply. Partners should treat fee transparency and annual contracting as design requirements, not afterthoughts.

International & bilingual landscape

French-medium provision still anchors much of the upper-middle market (AEFE / OSUI and mission schools; published Lyautey bands $\approx$ MAD 40.8k-48.2k for 2026/27). American / IB schools remain the price ceiling (e.g. Casablanca American School $\approx$ MAD 94k-163k; George Washington Academy $\approx$ MAD 99k-174k on published schedules).

British provision is no longer nascent. Active names include British International School of Casablanca (BISC), London Academy (Casablanca / Bouskoura and Rabat; published Casablanca tuition $\approx$ MAD 36k-69k for 2026/27), International School of Morocco (BSO / IB primary), plus Cambridge-linked options in Tangier (e.g. Everest) and longer-standing Anglo-Moroccan provision. Local groups (Elbilila, Holged / Yassamine-Al Jabr and others) continue to add English / international streams.

Implication for Ellesmere partners: the MAD 60-90k “value premium” gap between French mission pricing and American / IB premiums is still real — but several British and hybrid operators already sit in or below that band. Win on brand depth, pastoral offer, network quality assurance and campus quality.

4. Regional market analysis

City narratives below follow Draft 1.2's structure. Opportunity judgements are retained where still valid; competition wording is tightened where Draft 1.2 overstated white space.

4.1 Casablanca (Greater Casablanca)

Still Morocco's deepest education market: largest metro economy, densest affluent catchment, most international schools. Premium American / IB and French incumbents operate near capacity in established districts. Central Casablanca remains high-scale but saturated and site-constrained — better as a catchment for a suburban campus than as a first greenfield city-centre build.

Updated competition note: British options are established (BISC; London Academy in Bouskoura; ISM). Draft 1.2's "gap in mid-premium British schools" should be read as room to differentiate a heritage UK independent brand with network QA — not absence of British supply.

4.2 Rabat

Still a Tier-1 partner priority. Diplomatic and professional families, strong fee capacity, high brand visibility, and cultural affinity with British education. Fewer full Nursery–Y13 British campuses than Casablanca, though London Academy also operates in Rabat and American / French incumbents are strong. Best framed as a flagship prestige + durability play for brand-licensing partners.

4.3 Bouskoura & Casablanca growth corridors

Draft 1.2 correctly identified Bouskoura and adjacent new zones as the practical Casablanca entry: affluent villa / gated-community growth, easier land assembly, developer partnership potential. That thesis stands.

Renewal correction: do not describe Bouskoura as low-saturation British white space. BISC and London Academy already serve the corridor. Residential growth can still support additional mid-premium capacity, especially with a differentiated Ellesmere proposition and careful micro-location (including Zenata and other eastern / corridor nodes called out in Draft 1.2).

4.4 Tangier

Port, free-zone and automotive investment continue to expand the professional class. Draft 1.2's first-mover language should be softened: Cambridge-oriented and Anglo-Moroccan provision exists (including Everest's Cambridge accreditation narrative and the longer-standing Anglo-Moroccan School). Mid-fee British heritage density remains lighter than Casa-Rabat, so Tangier stays a strong second-wave / northern network node.

4.5 Marrakesh

Still a medium, niche market: lifestyle / tourism / upper-local demand; American School of Marrakesh and other internationals present. Suitable as a later network phase rather than a volume flagship. Cultural expectations for Arabic / Islamic studies alongside British pathways remain relevant.

4.6 Agadir

Limited international stack beyond the French mission and thinner English options. Absolute demand is modest; white-space ratio is high. Keep as a southern regional node after a Moroccan flagship is proven.

4.7 Fès & El Jadida

Watchlist / partnership-led only. Fès has French and limited American provision; fee pools are thinner. El Jadida's industrial corridor creates some professional demand, but scale may not support multiple mid-premium internationals — Draft 1.2's caution still applies.

4.8 Témara / Salé / Kénitra (Rabat periphery)

Still a credible overflow thesis: residential spillover from Rabat, improving employment nodes (e.g. Kénitra industry / free zone). High accessibility opportunity if priced and positioned for upper-middle families who cannot or will not commute into central Rabat premium schools.

5. Competitive landscape & tuition benchmarking (updated)

Draft 1.2's three-tier mental model still works. Numbers below refresh published schedules and aggregator medians for 2025/26–2026/27. Always verify total cost (registration, transport, meals, exams).

Value / French mission — ≈ MAD 40,000–55,000

Lycée Lyautey published 2026/27 bands ≈ MAD 40,800–48,200. Remains the academically strong value benchmark for many Moroccan families.

Accessible British / bilingual international — ≈ MAD 36,000–70,000

London Academy Casablanca published ≈ MAD 36,000–69,000 (2026/27). École Belge de Casablanca ≈ MAD 47,060–68,580. Several hybrid / bilingual locals sit in or just below this range.

Mid-premium international (Ellesmere alignment) — MAD 60,000–90,000

Still the intended band. Casablanca international schools that publish fees show a median around MAD 66,500 (doris, 2026). BISC does not publish a public fee schedule in major aggregators; Draft 1.2's parent-forum estimate of ~MAD 70–80k for early grades should be treated as indicative only until confirmed.

Premium American / IB — ≈ MAD 90,000–175,000+

Casablanca American School ≈ MAD 93,678–163,054 (2025/26 published). George Washington Academy ≈ MAD 99,450–173,700 (2026/27 published). American Academy Casablanca also publishes high bands. These remain the price ceiling Draft 1.2 described.

Positioning conclusion (renewed): an Ellesmere-licensed school at MAD 60–90k still sits in the trade-up zone between French value and American / IB ultra-premium — but must expect active British and hybrid competitors inside or adjacent to that band, especially in Greater Casablanca.

6. Outlook for brand-licensing partners

Morocco offers both a near-term campus opportunity and a longer-term North African platform. Demographics, private-sector scale (≈1.27 million private students in 2025–26), and policy openness remain favourable. The competitive field is more crowded in British / English pathways than Draft 1.2 sometimes implied — particularly around Casablanca's southern suburbs.

Priority partner locations remain Rabat, Bouskoura / Greater Casablanca suburbs, and Tangier. Success depends on local partnership, cultural fluency (Arabic / national programmes alongside British pathways), fee transparency under Law 59.21, and clear differentiation on Ellesmere's heritage brand and pastoral model.

Commercial model reminder: partners invest and operate; ECI licenses brand and standards. That is the product this briefing supports.

7. Sources used for this renewal

- Ministère de l'Éducation Nationale — 2025–26 enrolment as reported by Morocco World News / Express TV (Sept 2025): 8,271,256 total; 1,266,723 private; 7,004,533 public.
- Law 59.21 school education framework — fee transparency, annual contracts, ban on in-year increases (SNRT News / La Relève reporting).

- International Schools Database — Casablanca published fee schedules 2025/26–2026/27 (Lyautey, CAS, GWA, London Academy, Belgian School, etc.).
- doris — Casablanca international tuition median $\approx$ MAD 66,500 (2026).
- men.gov.ma; hcp.ma; AMDIE — structural / regulatory context retained from Draft 1.2 source list.
- Base document: Neil Tomalin, Private K-12 Education in Morocco — Market Overview & Opportunity Analysis, Draft 1.2, 25 July 2025.

Disclaimer: For qualified investor and operator partners. Figures are compiled from public sources and may change; they are not a prospectus or a school fee quote. Confirm regulation, licensing and school-level fees locally before investment decisions. Ellesmere College International — March 2026.